

GIFT CITY AT A GLANCE...

Q. What is GIFT City?

Gujarat International Finance Tec-City, or GIFT City, in Gujarat's Gandhinagar is the first ground-up smart city in India which hosts the country's only International Financial Services Centre.

Q. Who owns and runs it?

GIFT City is a public-private-partnership (PPP). GIFT City Ltd, a Gujarat government-owned company, has been entrusted with developing the city. Earlier, a joint venture with IL&FS, Gujarat Urban Development Company Ltd., acquired its 50% stake in 2020.

Q. How big is it?

It is spread over 886 acres, which includes 261 acres of special economic zone (SEZ) hosting the IFSC and 625 acres for the domestic tariff area, which is the non-SEZ zone designed for businesses focused on the domestic market.

Q. How is it being developed?

Private players, including some large real estate developers, have property developments. Social infrastructure is also being scaled up. Lilavati Hospital is coming up. Accor Hotel is already there. The GIFT City Club is managed by Radisson. Hyatt will open a five-star hotel. Other



Clockwise: The Deakin University Campus in GIFT City; the surveillance room at GIFT City; 16-km-long, eight-metre-wide underground utility tunnel network; GIFT City Metro

facilities like schools, parks are also being developed.

The city has state-of-the-art civic infra, including a fully automated waste management plant and collection via a network of chutes and pipelines. It also centrally cooled.

Q. What is the aim behind setting up GIFT City?

The government wants to make GIFT City the gateway to global capital by rerouting the flow of financial services, whether in-bound or out-bound, a lot of it currently happening offshore in other countries, whether its Singapore or Dubai or Mauritius.

Q. What is the revenue model?

The revenue generation is pri-

Mirae's Indian arm, Mirae Asset Investment Managers India, also offers a global allocation fund, a restricted (non-retail) scheme classified as an AIF.

Vaibhav Shah, Head, Products, Business Strategy and International Business, Mirae Asset Investment Managers, says the fund has received a good response with close to \$70 million in AUM. "Last

month alone, we got \$40-45 million. Despite the volatility in equity markets, the flow was strong and we could buy at the bottom," says Shah.

Mirae plans to launch a retail-focused outbound fund from GIFT that will allow a significantly larger set of domestic investors to channel money abroad. But it is prioritising the AIF, which is getting good response from family offices and

institutional investors, says Shah. It also plans to launch ETFs.

Several other fund houses have also launched their outbound funds through GIFT City. DSP Asset Managers's Global Equity Fund is targeting retail investors; the minimum investment is \$5,000.

Exchanges like India INX are also expanding their offerings to include listing and trading of ETFs,